whose narrative stopped at 1940. It excavated, perhaps in excessive detail, its subject's erratic and undistinguished career before that date. But of course, all Churchill's failures were redeemed by his heroic leadership during the Second World War. It is tempting to see Nehru's career as being Churchill's in reverse, insofar as it was marked for many decades by achievement and success, these nullified by the massive, humiliating failure, with regard to China, which broke his nation's morale and broke his own spirit and body. The war was fought in October–November 1962; a year and a half later, Nehru was dead.

II

The four towering figures of twentieth-century India were Rabindranath Tagore, Mohandas K. Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru and B.R. Ambedkar. All four had a close connection with England, a country they each spent extended periods in, and by whose literature and politics they were deeply influenced. But all also had a long engagement with a second foreign country. In the case of Tagore, this was Japan, which he visited on four separate occasions, and whose culture and art he greatly admired. In the case of Gandhi, this second country was South Africa, where he spent two decades working as a lawyer, community organizer and activist. In the case of Ambedkar it was the United States, where he studied, and by whose democratic traditions he was influenced.

As for Nehru, other than India and England, the country that interested him most was China. His first major book, *Glimpses of World History*, published in 1935, has as many as 134 index references to China. These refer to, among other things, different dynasties (the Tang, Han, Ch'in, etc.), corruption, Communism, civil war, agriculture, and banditry. Already, the pairing of China and India was strongly imprinted in Nehru's framework. Thus, China is referred to as 'the other great country of Asia' and as 'India's old-time friend'. There was a manifest sympathy with its troubles at the hands of foreigners. The British were savaged for forcing both humiliating